Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date: 03 October 2026

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Project Name: Script-Controlled ACL – Restrict Record Access Based on Field Value

Maximum Marks: 4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas

User Persona

Primary User: ServiceNow application user with an assigned role

Secondary User: ServiceNow administrator responsible for managing access permissions

User Goal:
Access only the records permitted by the user's role and the Branch value while preventing unauthorized access to restricted records.

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1. SAYS

- “I should be able to view the records I am authorized to access.”
- “I need access according to my assigned role.”
- “I should not be able to see records that are restricted.”
- “The administrator should have complete access when required.”
- “The system should clearly enforce the access permissions.”

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2. THINKS

- “Can I access the records assigned to my branch?”
- “Does my role give me the required permission?”
- “Are records belonging to other branches protected?”
- “Can an unauthorized user access these records?”
- “Are the ACL rules correctly configured?”

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3. DOES

- Logs into the ServiceNow instance.
- Accesses the Institution Details records.
- Attempts to view records based on the assigned role.
- Tests access to records having different Branch values.
- Creates, modifies or deletes records when the corresponding permissions are available.
- Uses different users and roles to verify access restrictions.

The project specifically requires testing users with and without the required role and verifying administrator access.

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4. FEELS

- **Concerned** about unauthorized access to records.
- **Concerned** about modification or deletion of restricted data.
- **Confident** when access permissions work as expected.
- **Secure** when unauthorized users are prevented from accessing records.
- **Satisfied** when the ACL provides the required level of record security.

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5. PAINS

- Unauthorized users may access restricted records if ACLs are not properly configured.
- Users may be unable to access records they are supposed to view.
- Incorrect role assignments can result in improper access.
- Incorrect ACL configuration can expose sensitive records.
- Uncontrolled create, write or delete permissions can affect data integrity.

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6. GAINS

- Controlled record-level access.
- Role-based permission management.
- Branch-based restriction of records.

- Protection against unauthorized viewing.
- Controlled CREATE, WRITE and DELETE operations.
- Full access for administrators.
- Easier verification of security permissions.

The project implements separate ACLs for READ, CREATE, WRITE and DELETE operations, with different roles assigned to the corresponding operations.

Empathy Map Summary

Category	Key Findings
Says	Wants secure and authorized access to records
Thinks	Wonders whether the assigned role permits access
Does	Accesses records and tests different permissions
Feels	Wants security, confidence and controlled access
Pains	Unauthorized access and incorrect permissions
Gains	Secure, role-based and field-based record access

Key Insight

The user needs a **secure and predictable access-control mechanism** where the system evaluates the user's role and record information before granting access. The proposed script-controlled ACL addresses this requirement by enforcing permissions at the record level.